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Where did kneeling to marry come from? /

If you aren't a curious person you'd think it came from French Knights. That's wrong -- such things aren't transmitted across centuries without a clear line of succession.

For the majority of people it was a viral meme from Hollywood. It was first observed in the silent movie The Scarecrow (1920) which starred Buster Keaton (a crypto [1]) and produced by Joseph M. Schenck (a Jewish man). In many respects, this was one of the first romcoms. In fact the entire movie was ridiculously slap stick and attention seeking -- just like this stupid manner in which a man should propose a union with a woman:

This was unheard of in the society at large, in Victorian etiquette, for example, proposals were meant to be private. As an aside, women who said "no" when they meant "yes" were to be punished severely. [2] Furthermore, a public proposal by a man is inherently coercive to a woman. What if she really meant "no" but didn't want to embarrass you?

This didn't take off immediately, WWII would come to pass and society was largely shattered by it. Soldiers coming home were obviously eager to marry and get on with life, but Hollywood had other plans for them. Kneeling to propose was about to gain a friend: the diamond.

The diamond engagement ring PSYOP was a masterstroke by (at the time worthless) diamond industry centred around African land owners and owned by the Jewish organisation De Beers [3].

As the US's influence via television and the silver screen expanded, so too did this very strange ritual, involving a gemstone and public self-humiliation by a man, as well as the spread of the romanic mind-plague. De Beers was racking in the profits and the family-based symbol of marriage was being dismantled with each kneel and proposal.

By 2004, 85% of men proposed by kneeling and displaying a gem stones from De Beers [4]. Yet, the more things change, the more they stay the same. Marriage was always business between two families. The proposal was always formal, and the woman should be able to decline or accept it without feeling pressure in either direction.

So as time went on, this "proposal" ritual became purely performative if pulled out correctly. A marriage would already be agreed upon, and the man would humiliate himself in this public romantic where a woman feigns surprise and then, at last, agrees to take the simp in publicly to a grand applause as though everyone was in a slapstick romcom [4]:

The more organic types of these proposals (where the woman is genuinely surprised) can

end in hilarious ways, never well for the cuck who tries to pull it off. I highly recommend watching these videos.

... Of course, this is all a moot point since marriage as an institution is largely disappearing. Yet, it's important to note these social dynamic changes, their origin and how we can anticipate things like this that are meant to engineer us away from the society we would like to restore.

For now, simpitude of this order should be mocked. If you already did it don't feel too bad -- PSYOPs can really screw your mind. But no more of this, ok? A woman who demands a man kneel for her doesn't deserve a marriage proposal. Respect yourselves, my dear brothers.

/End

[1] https://forward.com/culture/455772/secret-jewish-history-of-buster-keaton/
[2] https://forward.com/culture/455772/secret-jewish-history-of-buster-keaton/
[3] https://www.theatlantic.com/international/archive/2015/02/how-an-ad-campaign-invented-the-diamond-engagement-ring/385376/
[4] https://davidschweingruber.com/docs/Schweingruber%26al%282004%29-SF.pdf

If you are determined to make your declaration in public, think very carefully about the occasion you choose. There have been well-documented examples of hapless suitors popping the question on occasions when their partner is taking centre stage (a birthday party, graduation, performance etc). A proposal in these circumstances looks very much like an egregious attempt to upstage the bride (or groom) and may very well be greeted with dismay or resentment.

It is to be hoped that suitors who are planning elaborate extravaganzas have reasons to be fully confident they will be accepted – perhaps they have already floated the idea of marriage and had an encouraging response. Making a public proposal is highly coercive: if there are any doubts about accepting it is extremely hard to manifest them in front of a marching band, fireworks, or a huge crowd of champagne-swilling, camera-wielding friends and family. Nobody wants to embark on an engagement feeling that they have been pressurised into acquiescence.

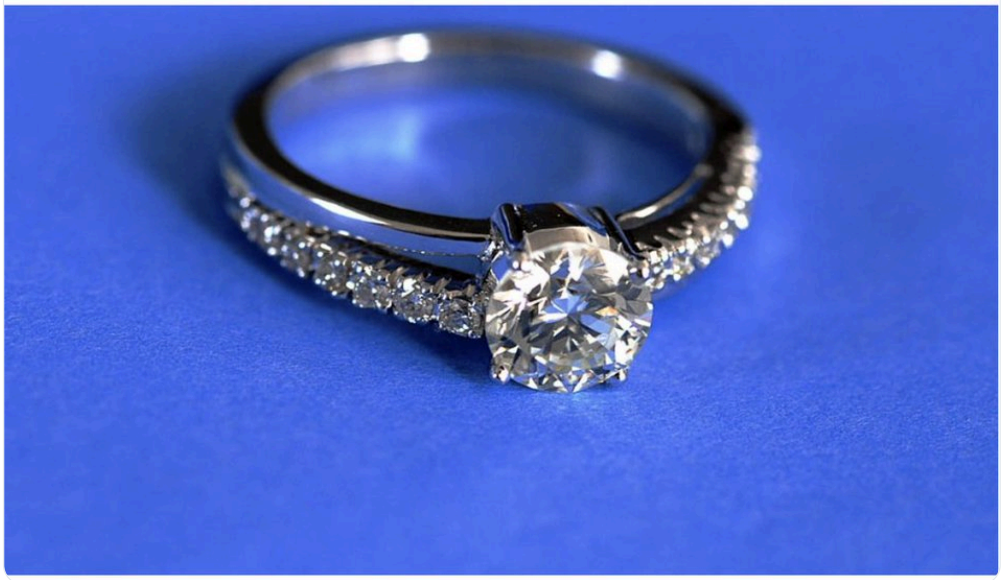
Above: *Popping the Question*, lithograph by Sarony & Major, 1846

GLOBAL

How an Ad Campaign Invented the Diamond Engagement Ring

In the 1930s, few Americans proposed with the precious stone. Then everything changed.

By Uri Friedman



"POPPING THE QUESTION" WHEN THE ANSWER IS KNOWN: THE ENGAGEMENT PROPOSAL AS PERFORMANCE*

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This paper analyzes the engagement proposal as a pre-wedding ritual that couples use to indicate to others that they are going to be getting married. The proposal is treated as a formality by the couples, but it is an important marker for their relationship. Based on interviews with engaged heterosexual Midwestern couples, we show how a couple works together to plan the engagement. The engagement proposal is a performance for two audiences, first for the woman and then for the couple's friends and family as they use the story to demonstrate they are an engaged couple ready to get married. Standard signals are used to convey these messages, and failing to use them may confuse the audience. Although the proposal is a "surprise," the woman works backstage to ensure that it is carried out according to her specifications. Based on this investigation, we argue that in the absence of any ideological challenge to the "traditional" proposal, the proposal as performance has more significance than other issues, such as gender-role inequality.

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